(Link: www.nhs.uk/)

What is an IUD (intrauterine device) or copper coil?



- An IUD (intrauterine device), also called a copper coil, is a small plastic T-shape that a doctor or nurse puts into your womb (uterus).
- It does not use hormones. It stops pregnancy by releasing copper into the womb.
- An IUD is not suitable for everyone.
- An IUD is over 99% effective.
- It works as soon as it's put in and lasts for 5 or 10 years, depending on the type.
- An IUD can also be used as a form of emergency contraception (Link: www.nhs.uk/contraception/emergency-contraception/).
- It’s safe to use while breastfeeding.
- After an IUD is removed your fertility will return to previous levels straight away.
- This information is about the copper coil. For information about the hormonal coil, see intrauterine system (IUS) (Link: www.nhs.uk/contraception/methods-of-contraception/ius-hormonal-coil/).
- You can compare different methods, including how well they work and side effects, when choosing a method of contraception (Link: www.nhs.uk/contraception/choosing-contraception/).

> An IUD does not stop you getting or passing on sexually transmitted infections (STIs) (Link: www.nhs.uk/conditions/sexually-transmitted-infections-stis/). Use a condom every time you have sex to protect you and your partner against STIs including HIV (Link: www.nhs.uk/conditions/hiv-and-aids/).

More in IUD (intrauterine device) or copper coil (Link: www.nhs.uk/contraception/methods-of-contraception/iud-coil/)

What is an IUD?

Where to get it (Link: https://www.nhs.uk/contraception/methods-of-contraception/iud-coil/where-to-get-it/)

Who can get it (Link: https://www.nhs.uk/contraception/methods-of-contraception/iud-coil/who-can-get-it/)

Getting it fitted or removed (Link: https://www.nhs.uk/contraception/methods-of-contraception/iud-coil/getting-it-fitted-or-removed/)

Side effects and risks (Link: https://www.nhs.uk/contraception/methods-of-contraception/iud-coil/side-effects/)

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